

FILM DOSSIER: ETERNALS

Phase 4 · Film #8 (Saga Two, Film #8 · Overall Film #37)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE.  Three showrunner casting decisions needed (see Section 2).

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	Saga Two #8 (Phase 4, Film #8) · MCU #37
Phase	Phase 4, The Secret Wars Saga
Real title	<i>ETERNALS</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"HOMECOMING PARADE"</i>
Release date	Friday, May 3, 2024
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Chloé Zhao
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 164 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + cosmic mythological epic

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	The Eternals ensemble , led by Richard Madden (Ikaris) and Gemma Chan (Sersi)

Character	Actor	Age at release
Ikaris	Richard Madden	37
Sersi	Gemma Chan	41
Thena	Angelina Jolie	48
Kingo	Kumail Nanjiani	46
Phastos	Brian Tyree Henry	42
Druig	Barry Keoghan	31
Gilgamesh ("the Forgotten One")	Don Lee	53
Ajak	⚠️ <i>see decision 1</i>	–
Makkari	⚠️ <i>see decision 2</i>	–
Sprite	⚠️ <i>see decision 3</i>	–
Dane Whitman	Kit Harington	37
Kro (<i>Deviant warlord; voice and performance capture</i>)	Bill Skarsgård	33
Arishem the Judge (<i>a Celestial</i>)	Voice (fresh casting)	–
Eros / Starfox (<i>post-credit</i>)	Harry Styles	30
Pip the Troll (<i>post-credit</i>)	Danny DeVito	79
Thanos (<i>post-credit</i>)	Josh Brolin	56

⚠️ SHOWRUNNER DECISIONS (616 gender)

On 616, **Ajak, Makkari and Sprite are male**. The only real actors to have played them are **women**. Under the Casting Rules they'd get the roles, but that changes the characters' genders, and **only Thor and Hawkeye are authorized to change**. (For the same reason, Mar-Vell was made a casting exception.)

#	Character	Casting Rules pick	Keep the 616 gender (exception)
1	Ajak	Salma Hayek (57)	Fresh male casting
2	Makkari	Lauren Ridloff (46), who, like her character in the real film, is Deaf	Fresh male casting
3	Sprite (<i>forever a child</i>)	Lia McHugh (17)	Fresh male casting

Recommendation: keep the 616 genders with fresh male casting for all three, as with Mar-Vell. Nobody is changed except the characters you've authorized.

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>The Eternals</i> #1–19 (1976–78), Jack Kirby: the Celestials arrive for their Fourth Host to judge Earth , and the Eternals (Ikaris, Sersi, Thena, Makkari, Ajak, Sprite, Kingo, Phastos, Druig, Gilgamesh) face the Deviants (Kro). <i>Eternals</i> #1–7 (2006), Neil Gaiman & John Romita Jr.: Sprite wiped the Eternals' memories because he resents being a child forever .
Supporting comics	<i>Iron Man</i> #55 (1973), Jim Starlin: Thanos is an Eternal of Titan , and Eros (Starfox) is his brother · Hickman's <i>New Avengers</i> / <i>Avengers</i> (2015): the Beyonders destroy the Celestials (seeded)
Nerf check	✅ The Celestials are above even the Eternals . The Eternals can't beat Arishem . They win by persuasion . Ikaris is at full strength , with flight and cosmic eye-beams.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	94% (96% if the 616 genders are kept). Kirby's cosmic story and Gaiman's memory twist are adapted closely.

Straight from the page:

- **A million years ago, the Celestials** experimented on early humans and created **the Eternals** (immortal and powerful) and **the Deviants** (monstrous and unstable) (*Eternals* #1).
- **The Fourth Host**: the Celestials **return to judge Earth**, and **Arishem** stands in judgment for **fifty years** (*Eternals* #1–19).
- **Kro**, the Deviant warlord (#1).
- **Sprite**, eternally a child, **erased the Eternals' memories** so they'd live as ordinary humans (Gaiman #1–7).
- **Thanos** is one of the **Eternals of Titan**, and **Eros/Starfox** is his brother (*Iron Man* #55).

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Ikaris	Flight, eye-beams, super strength, cosmic energy, immortality	Flies through a volcano	–	✓ 100%
Sersi	Matter transmutation	Turns a bus into flowers	–	✓ 100%
Thena	Cosmic weapon forging ; master warrior	Makes swords from light	–	✓ 100%
Makkari	Super speed	Runs around the Earth	–	✓ 100%
The Celestials	Near-omnipotence ; world-judges	Arishem stops a war with a gesture	–	✓ 100%
Kro	Deviant shapeshifter warlord	Leads the Deviant armies	–	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	Gods who don't remember they're gods wake up to find that the Celestials who made them have come back to judge the Earth, and something out there is killing the Celestials first.
Theme	Judgment and purpose. Who has the right to decide a world's fate? <i>(It echoes the Illuminati's choice.)</i>
Villain / antagonist	Kro and the Deviants ; Sprite (a betrayal); Arishem (judgment, not evil)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: FORGOTTEN GODS

- **Monday, January 8, 2024.** A London schoolteacher, **Sersi**, turns a coffee cup into glass without meaning to. A man who can **fly** comes to find her: **Ikaris**.
- **Sprite** made them forget everything, **and the spell is breaking**.

ACT TWO: THE FOURTH HOST

- The **Celestials** arrive. **Arishem**, a mile tall, stands over the Andes to **judge Earth**.
- **Kro and the Deviants** come out of the ground to wipe out humanity before the judgment ends.
- The Eternals **remember** who they are and **reunite** across the world.

ACT THREE: JUDGMENT

- The Eternals beat Kro's army.
 - **Sersi** speaks to Arishem **on humanity's behalf**. He **withholds judgment**, and then **looks up toward space** as if he's heard something.
 - **A second Celestial falls dead** out of the sky over the ocean, killed by something unseen.
 - Arishem **leaves in a hurry**, without a verdict.
 - The Eternals look at the corpse of a god.
-

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, January 8, 2024 → Saturday, April 13, 2024.
Where it's set	London · the Andes (filmed in Peru and the Canary Islands) · Olympia (the Eternals' city) · the Pacific (the dead Celestial)
Relative to other films	It overlaps the end of <i>Daredevil: Born Again</i>. A dead Celestial in the ocean is on every news channel.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **The Eternals, the Deviants, the Celestials, Olympia.**

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Thanos is an Eternal	The post-credit scene	Thanos's return (Saga Two)
Dane Whitman	He finds the Ebony Blade	The Black Knight, later

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Someone is killing Celestials	The corpse over the Pacific	The Beyonders are on the move. On 616 they wiped out the Celestials in <i>Time Runs Out</i> (2015).

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "THE BLADE." Dane Whitman opens an old family trunk and finds the Ebony Blade . A voice: <i>"Are you sure you're ready for that, Mr. Whitman?"</i>
Post-credit scene	✓ "BROTHER." A farm on a distant world. Thanos , in plain clothes, is harvesting grain. A ship lands. Out step Eros (Starfox) , Thanos's grinning brother, and Pip the Troll . EROS: <i>"Hello, brother. The Celestials are dying. Everyone's dying. And you're farming."</i> Thanos keeps harvesting. CUT TO BLACK. "THE ETERNALS WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "ATTIC." Post-credit: "FAMILY FARM."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline · ⌚ Three gender casting decisions